

01 SMALL TALK

When you meet someone new, do you remember their name easily, or forget it right away?

Do you check your phone messages the moment they come in, or let them sit for a while?

Who was the last new person you talked to this week — even just for a minute?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

① ~~"I want to develop myself."~~

✓ "I want to grow as a person."

사람한테는 develop 대신 grow나 improve를 써요. 능력엔 develop my skills.

② ~~"My company is very welfare."~~

✓ "My company has great benefits."

회사 복지는 welfare가 아니라 benefits나 perks예요. welfare는 정부 복지를 뜻해요.

③ ~~"I resigned my job."~~

✓ "I quit my job."

resign은 목적어 없이 쓰거나, quit my job이 자연스러워요.

03 오늘의 워업

앞은 자리에서 손가락으로 A(1) 또는 B(2) 표시. 한 라운드마다 한 명 짧게 이유 한 문장. 5분 안에 끝.

WARM-UP

This or That · 빠른 5라운드

1

Exchange business cards VS Connect on LinkedIn

2

Big networking event VS 1-on-1 coffee chat

3

Follow up within 3 days VS Wait until you need something

4

Know 100 people loosely VS Know 10 people deeply

5

Talk about work VS Talk about hobbies

Networking in Korea — Useful Contacts or Awkward Small Talk?

BACKGROUND

한국에서 네트워킹은 유용한 인맥 만들기처럼 보이지만, 막상 해보면 어색한 스몰톡처럼 느껴질 때가 많아요. 명함을 주고받거나 링크드인으로 연결되는 것보다 중요한 건, 그 이후에 자연스럽게 다시 연락할 이유가 생기는지예요. 억지로 많은 사람을 아는 것보다, 서로에게 실제로 도움이 되는 대화를 만드는 게 더 어렵고 더 중요해요. 네트워킹은 인맥의 넓이보다 후속 대화의 질에서 갈려요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Networking in Korea can feel useful in theory but awkward in practice. Meeting people at an event, trading phone numbers, or adding someone online does not create a real connection by itself. The hard part is the follow-up: finding a natural reason to message again, ask a question, or share something useful without sounding forced. Some people treat networking as collecting names. Others see it as building trust slowly, one real conversation at a time. In the end, the value depends less on how many people you know, and more on whether the relationship can survive past the first polite small talk.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

break the ice — 어색함을 풀다

follow up — 후속 연락을 하다

stay in touch — 연락하고 지내다

small talk — 가벼운 잡담

keep the door open — 가능성을 열어두다

get my foot in the door — 첫 기회를 잡다

TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, networking feels more ___ to me, because ___.

It depends on the situation, but usually I find it ___ when ___.

The harder part for me is ___, since ___.

Compared to ___, ___ feels way tougher because ___.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'swap business cards' or a 'just save the phone number' person when you meet someone new at a work gathering?
- 2 When was the last time you went to a networking event or 모임 just to meet new people for work?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick: work events, 회식, or online like LinkedIn — where do you meet most of your work contacts?
- 4 On a scale of 1 to 5, how often do you actually open LinkedIn in a normal week?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Does networking feel more useful or more awkward to you? Why?

↳ Honestly, networking feels more ___ to me, because ___.

↳ It depends on the situation, but usually I find it ___ when ___.

Q2. Which is harder for you — starting the first conversation, or following up later?

↳ The harder part for me is ___, since ___.

↳ Compared to ___, ___ feels way tougher because ___.

Q3. Would you rather know many people a little, or a few people very well?

↳ I'd rather ___, because ___ matters more to me than ___.

↳ When I think about it, I lean toward ___ — ___.

Q4. Can networking feel real, or does it always feel a little fake?

↳ I'd say networking can feel real when ___.

↳ Most of the time it feels ___, but it changes when ___.

Q5. How do you know a contact is actually useful, not just a name in your phone?

↳ The way I know is ___ — ___.

↳ What helps me decide is whether ___.